

INTERVIEW PREPARATION · MBB LABS · MAYBANK GROUP

Senior Product Owner



A complete, JD-aligned training pack for the MBB Labs (Maybank's Bengaluru offshore development centre) Senior Product Owner role — core banking, lending & collateral systems, risk-based pricing, deposit management, risk analytics, system architecture diagrams, SQL, and the full product-ownership craft.

Mapped directly to the job description:

Core banking · Rating system · Risk-based pricing · Lending principles · Deposit management · PCI DSS · Risk analytics · Loan origination / collateral / servicing systems · Asset & liability classes · Functional design → MIS · Data visualization · Software product lifecycle · AGILE · JIRA & Confluence · Basic SQL · Product implementation · Stakeholder & delivery leadership

How to use: Start with §2 (“The JD, decoded”) to see the whole map, then read end-to-end and drill the Q&A and the “explain this diagram” exercise out loud.

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1 · Your employer: Maybank & MBB Labs

The role is **Senior Product Owner** at **MBB Labs Private Limited**, the **Bengaluru (Bangalore) offshore development centre** of Maybank, reporting to the Head of Product Management. MBB Labs is positioned as a **software product development organisation** building digital and high-end analytics products to help Maybank become a “next-gen bank of choice.” So you sit in India, building products for a Malaysian/ASEAN bank — an **international** working environment by design.

Maybank facts (straight from the JD — quote these)

- **4th largest bank in South-East Asia**, total assets > **RM 722 billion**.
- 2,400+ branches/offices in **20 countries**; **44,000+** employees; **22 million** customers.
- The **only regional bank present in all 10 ASEAN countries**; a **global leader in Islamic Finance**.
- Mission: “**humanise financial services**” — fair terms & pricing, at the heart of the community.

T.I.G.E.R. — Maybank's core values JD

LETTER	VALUE	SHOW IT IN ANSWERS BY...
T	Teamwork	Crediting the squad; cross-functional collaboration.
I	Integrity	Compliance-by-design; honest trade-off conversations.
G	Growth	Mentoring juniors; learning new domains quickly.
E	Excellence & Efficiency	Outcome metrics; lean delivery; quality bar.
R	Relationship Building	Stakeholder engagement across Bengaluru & KL.

FRAME YOUR WHOLE INTERVIEW AROUND THREE THINGS

(1) Humanising / customer value · **(2)** Islamic-first & regulatory compliance · **(3)** Delivery excellence with technical teams. Anchor every answer to one of these and the T.I.G.E.R. values, and you'll sound like a Maybank insider.

2 · The JD, decoded — every point

This is your map. Every requirement in the job description, what it really means, and where in this pack you'll find the depth. Read this table first.

JD REQUIREMENT	WHAT THEY WANT YOU TO KNOW / SAY	§
Core Banking	The system of record (CIF, CASA, loans, GL); keep it stable, innovate in the digital layer via APIs/events.	4
Lending principles	5 Cs, the end-to-end loan lifecycle, affordability (DSR), secured vs unsecured.	5
Loan origination, Collateral & servicing systems	LOS, collateral management & valuation, LMS/servicing — what each does and the data they hold.	6
Deposit Management	Liability products (CASA, fixed deposits), cost of funds, CASA ratio, ALM.	7
Asset & liability classes / international markets	Balance-sheet view: assets (loans, securities) vs liabilities (deposits, borrowings); ALM, interest-rate & liquidity risk.	7
Rating system	Internal credit risk rating — obligor (PD) & facility (LGD) grades, scorecards, masterscale.	8
Risk-based pricing	Rate = cost of funds + expected loss + capital + margin; price to risk grade; SBR + spread.	8
Risk management & risk analytics	Credit/market/operational risk; Basel; PD·LGD·EAD; ECL/IFRS 9; stress testing.	9
PCI DSS compliance	Protecting cardholder data — 12 requirements, tokenisation, never store CVV, segmentation.	11
KYC / AML (CAMS)	Identity, screening, monitoring, SARs; why a product must “bake it in.”	11, 19
Functional design: data capture → app design → MIS	BRD/FSD, data dictionary, MIS & reporting; turning needs into specs.	15
Data visualization	Dashboards & BI (Power BI/Tableau/Qlik); choosing the right chart; KPIs.	15
Software product lifecycle / Product Implementation	Discovery → design → build → UAT → launch → hypercare → iterate.	18
AGILE methodology	Scrum roles & ceremonies; PO owns the backlog & “what/why.”	17
JIRA & Confluence	Epics → stories → sprints in JIRA; documentation in Confluence.	17
Basic SQL	SELECT/JOIN/GROUP BY; read & shape data, validate numbers.	16
Backlog ownership / maximise business value	Prioritisation frameworks (MoSCoW/RICE/WSJF); value vs effort.	17
Define functionality, features & roadmap with business	Vision → roadmap → OKRs; stakeholder discovery.	17, 18

End-to-end product lifecycle ownership	Own outcomes from idea to in-market performance.	18
Stakeholder mgmt in an international environment	Bengaluru ↔ KL; business, risk, compliance, Shariah, tech.	17, 20
Prioritise & navigate ambiguity	Decision-making with incomplete info; sequencing by value & risk.	17, 20
Quantitative / analytical / problem solving	Metrics, funnels, ratios, hypothesis-driven thinking.	9, 15, 16
Lead & mentor technical teams	Delivery leadership, collaboration, growing people (T.I.G.E.R. “Growth”).	17, 20
Education: Econ/Commerce/MBA; CAMS/KYC/FRM	Know what each certification signals.	19

NOTE ON GEOGRAPHY

The JD also mentions “international financial markets across all **asset and liability classes**,” so don't limit yourself to Malaysian retail. Speak to the broader balance sheet (loans, deposits, treasury/markets) and the ASEAN footprint — while still knowing the Malaysia specifics in §3, which show real domain depth.

3 · Malaysian banking in 5 minutes

Even building from Bengaluru, you're serving Maybank's markets. These terms signal real domain knowledge.

THING	WHAT IT IS
BNM — Bank Negara Malaysia	Central bank & regulator; sets policy, licenses banks, issues guidelines (responsible financing, Islamic, AML).
OPR → SBR	The Overnight Policy Rate (BNM benchmark) sets the Standardised Base Rate . Floating loan rate = $\text{SBR} + \text{spread}$.
CCRIS	BNM's mandatory central credit database — 12 months of repayment conduct. Malaysia's credit file.
CTOS / RAMCI / Experian	Private credit reporting agencies & scores (Credit Reporting Agencies Act 2010).
DSR	Debt Service Ratio — Malaysia's DTI; the affordability gate.
AKPK	BNM's credit-counselling & debt-management agency (loss-mitigation channel).
PIDM	Deposit insurance (& takaful) corporation.
PayNet	National rails: DuitNow (instant), RENTAS (RTGS), IBG, JomPAY, FPX.
PDPA 2010	Personal Data Protection Act — every digital product touches it.

ONE-LINER THAT LANDS

“A Malaysian floating-rate facility prices as **SBR + spread**, affordability is gated by **DSR** under BNM responsible-financing rules, and we assess credit on **CCRIS** + a CTOS score.”

4 · Core banking — heart of the bank JD

Core banking is the central system of record holding customer accounts and processing the fundamental transactions: opening accounts, deposits, booking loans/financing, posting debits/credits, calculating interest/profit, and maintaining the **general ledger (GL)**. (“CORE” $\approx$ *Centralised Online Real-time Environment*.) Everything else — apps, ATMs, lending workflows — reads from and writes to the core.

MODULE	OWNS
Customer / CIF	Customer Information File — the single golden record (the “360 view”).
CASA	Current Account & Savings Account — deposits, balances, posting.
Loans / Financing	Loan accounts, schedules, interest/profit accrual, delinquency status.
General Ledger	Double-entry accounting — every transaction posts here.
Term deposits	Fixed deposits / term financing.
Payments & clearing hooks	Links to RENTAS, DuitNow, IBG, cheque clearing.
Islamic banking module	Shariah-compliant accounting — profit not interest (see §10).

PO TALKING POINT

“The core is the **system of record**; we keep it thin and stable and build innovation in a **digital/microservices layer** that talks to it through APIs and events — ship fast on the edges without risking the ledger.” That's the modernisation story MBB Labs exists to deliver.

ACCURACY NOTE

Most Malaysian domestic banks (Maybank included) have historically run core banking on **Silverlake Axis's** platform — but internal stacks evolve (cloud, microservices). In the room, speak to **patterns** and present vendor names as “industry-reported,” not confidential fact.

5 · Lending principles & the loan lifecycle JD

The Five Cs of Credit

C	MEASURES	SIGNAL
Character	Willingness to repay	CCRIS conduct, CTOS score
Capacity	Ability to repay	DSR, cash flow
Capital	Skin in the game	Down payment, reserves
Collateral	Security	Margin of Finance / LTV, valuation
Conditions	Purpose & economy	Rate cycle, sector

The end-to-end loan lifecycle (Malaysia / Maybank)



STAGE	WHAT HAPPENS
1 Application	Apply on M2U/MAE, branch or agent; e-KYC vs MyKad ; PDPA consent; pick conventional or Islamic.
2 Credit assessment	Pull CCRIS + CTOS ; verify income (payslip, EPF/KWSP, EA/BE tax form); compute DSR ; BNM responsible-financing; auto-decision clean cases, refer complex.
3 Approval & pricing	Risk-based SBR + spread (or Islamic profit rate with ceiling); approve/counter/decline; issue Letter of Offer .
4 Offer & disbursement	Accept LO; sign facility agreement; create charge over property (National Land Code) or use Hire-Purchase Act 1967 for autos; stamp duty; MRTA/MRTT ; disburse (progressive for under-construction).
5 Servicing	Instalment via standing instruction/auto-debit/DuitNow; daily accrual; payment splits profit/interest + principal; statements; monthly CCRIS reporting.
6 Delinquency	Track months in arrears (MIA) ; collections within fair-practice limits; impaired at ~90 DPD; drives GIL ratio.
7 Rehabilitation	R&R (reschedule/restructure: extend tenure, lower instalment, moratorium); refer hardship to AKPK .
8 Recovery	Secured: foreclosure via court Order for Sale & auction (NLC) or vehicle repossession ; unsecured: charge-off & recovery/sale; provisions under MFRS 9 ECL .
9 Settlement	Full/early settlement or refinance; discharge of charge ; close & report settled to CCRIS.

Islamic note: same flow — say “financing” not “loan,” “profit” not “interest.”

6 · Origination, collateral & servicing systems JD

The JD specifically wants experience “building systems on loan originations, Collateral system, loan servicing systems.” Know what each system does and the data it owns — that’s exactly what a PO specs.

SYSTEM	OWNS / DOES	KEY DATA POINTS
LOS — Loan Origination System	Application intake, document & e-KYC, credit decisioning workflow, offer generation — everything <i>up to disbursement</i> .	Applicant, income, requested amount/tenure, decision, conditions, offer terms.
Collateral system	Records & values security; tracks the lien/charge; revaluation; links collateral to one or many facilities.	Collateral type, valuation & date, MOF/LTV, charge/perfection status, insurance.
LMS — Loan/Servicing System	Post-disbursement life: ledger, accrual, repayment processing, statements, delinquency, payoff. Often part of the core.	Schedule, outstanding, instalment, arrears bucket, accrued interest/profit, status.

COLLATERAL — THE DETAIL THAT IMPRESSES

“A facility can be secured by multiple collaterals, and one collateral can secure multiple facilities — so the data model is **many-to-many**, and we must track **perfection** (the charge under the NLC), **revaluation** cycles, and **available vs utilised** security value. Collateral quality feeds **LGD** and therefore pricing and provisioning.” That sentence ties collateral → risk → pricing, exactly the JD’s themes.

7 · Deposit management & asset/liability classes JD

Lending is the **asset** side; deposits are the **liability** side that funds it. The JD wants both, plus the balance-sheet view across “all asset and liability classes.”

Deposit (liability) products

PRODUCT	WHAT IT IS
CASA	Current & Savings Accounts — low/no interest, can be withdrawn anytime. Cheap, sticky funding.
Fixed / Term Deposit	Locked for a tenure at a fixed rate; pricier funding. Islamic equivalent uses Tawarruq/Mudarabah.
NIDs / money-market	Negotiable instruments & wholesale funding.

METRIC	WHY IT MATTERS
CASA ratio	$\text{CASA} \div \text{total deposits}$. Higher = cheaper funding = better margin. A headline bank KPI.
Cost of funds	Weighted rate the bank pays for deposits/borrowings — the floor under loan pricing.
NIM — net interest margin	$(\text{Interest income} - \text{interest expense}) \div \text{assets}$. Core profitability of the asset+liability spread.

Asset–Liability Management (ALM)

ALM is the discipline of matching the asset book (loans, securities) against the liability book (deposits, borrowings) to manage three risks:

- **Interest-rate risk** — assets and liabilities reprice at different speeds; if OPR moves, margin shifts.
- **Liquidity risk** — can the bank meet withdrawals/obligations? Measured by **LCR** (Liquidity Coverage Ratio) & **NSFR** (Net Stable Funding Ratio) under Basel III.
- **Maturity mismatch** — borrowing short (deposits) to lend long (30-yr mortgages) is the classic banking tension.

BALANCE-SHEET FRAMING

“A bank earns the **spread** between what assets yield and what liabilities cost, while managing rate, liquidity and credit risk. As a PO I design products on both sides — a financing product and the deposit product that funds it — with ALM and cost-of-funds in mind.” International markets add FX, bonds and money-market instruments across currencies.

8 · Rating systems & risk-based pricing JD

Credit risk rating system

A rating system converts a borrower/facility into a **risk grade** that drives approval, pricing, limits and capital. Two ratings combine:

RATING	ANSWERS	MAPS TO
Obligor / borrower rating	How likely is this borrower to default?	PD — probability of default
Facility rating	If they default, how much do we lose?	LGD — loss given default (driven by collateral)

- **Scorecards** turn data into a score: **application scorecards** (at origination) and **behavioural scorecards** (ongoing, from account conduct).
- Grades sit on a **masterscale** (e.g. 1–10 or AAA...D), each mapped to a PD band.
- Under Basel's **IRB** (Internal Ratings-Based) approach, banks use their own PD/LGD/EAD to compute capital; the alternative is the **Standardised** approach.

Risk-based pricing

Price the loan to its risk. The rate is built up from components:

COMPONENT	COVERS
Cost of funds	What the deposits/borrowings funding the loan cost (links to §7).
Operating cost	Origination & servicing overhead.
Expected loss	$EL = PD \times LGD \times EAD$ — the credit-risk premium from the rating.
Cost of capital	Return on the regulatory capital held against the loan.
Margin	Target profit spread.

In Malaysia the customer rate is expressed as **SBR + spread**, where the spread embeds the above; Islamic uses a **profit rate** with a contractual **Ceiling Profit Rate**.

THE CHAIN TO MEMORISE

Rating → **PD/LGD** → **Expected Loss** → **spread** → **price**. A worse risk grade means a higher PD, a higher expected loss, and therefore a higher spread. This single chain connects the JD's “rating system” and “risk-based pricing” — say it out loud.

9 · Risk management & risk analytics JD

The JD asks for a “sound conceptual foundation in banking, risk management practices” and exposure to “risk analytics.” Here's the foundation.

The three classic risk types

RISK	WHAT IT IS	MANAGED BY
Credit risk	Borrower fails to repay.	Ratings, limits, collateral, provisioning.
Market risk	Losses from moves in rates, FX, prices.	VaR, hedging, ALM.
Operational risk	Failures of people, process, systems, fraud.	Controls, RCSA, BCP.

Plus liquidity, compliance/conduct and reputational risk.

The risk analytics vocabulary

TERM	MEANING
PD · LGD · EAD	Probability of Default · Loss Given Default · Exposure at Default. $EL = PD \times LGD \times EAD$.
RWA	Risk-Weighted Assets — assets scaled by risk; capital is held as a % of RWA (Basel).
Basel III	Global capital & liquidity framework — capital ratios, LCR, NSFR.
ECL / IFRS 9 (MFRS 9)	Expected Credit Loss provisioning, staged 1 (performing) / 2 (deteriorated) / 3 (impaired).
Stress testing	Modelling losses under adverse scenarios (recession, rate shock).
Roll rates / vintage	How accounts migrate across delinquency buckets; performance by origination cohort.
Credit limits & concentration	Caps by borrower, sector, geography to avoid over-exposure.

PO ANGLE ON RISK ANALYTICS

“As a PO on a risk-analytics product I'd own the data pipeline from **origination data points** → features → the **rating/scoring** model → decisioning & pricing → **MIS dashboards** that show PD migration, ECL staging and portfolio concentration to risk officers.” That ties risk analytics to functional design and data viz (the JD's other asks).

10 · Islamic financing essentials

Maybank is a **global leader in Islamic finance** (per the JD), so expect a Shariah question. Golden rule: **no riba** (interest), **no gharar** (excessive uncertainty), no non-halal activity. Instead the bank structures a real trade/partnership

and earns **profit**.

CONTRACT	HOW IT WORKS	USED FOR
Murabahah	Cost-plus sale; bank buys, sells at cost + disclosed profit, in instalments.	Asset purchase
Tawarruq / Commodity Murabahah	Commodity buy/sell to generate cash; dominant for personal financing & deposits.	Personal financing, deposits
Musharakah Mutanaqisah	Diminishing partnership: co-own the property; customer buys out the bank's share + pays rent.	Home financing
Ijarah	Leasing — bank owns & leases the asset.	Vehicle / equipment

LANGUAGE SWAP

loan → **financing** · interest → **profit** · late interest → **ta'widh** / **gharamah** · every product needs **Shariah Committee** approval & ongoing governance.

11 · PCI DSS, KYC/AML & data security JD

PCI DSS — protecting card data

PCI DSS (Payment Card Industry Data Security Standard) is the mandatory standard for anyone who **stores, processes or transmits cardholder data**. It's not a law but it's enforced by the card networks; breaching it means fines and losing the ability to process cards.

PRINCIPLE (OF 12 REQUIREMENTS)	IN PRACTICE
Protect cardholder data	Encrypt the PAN (card number) at rest & in transit; mask when displayed.
Never store sensitive auth data	You may <i>never</i> store the CVV , full magnetic stripe, or PIN after authorisation.
Tokenisation	Replace the PAN with a token so systems downstream never touch real card data — shrinks PCI scope.
Network segmentation	Isolate the cardholder-data environment (CDE) from the rest of the network.
Access control & logging	Least-privilege access, MFA, and audit trails on all access to card data.

SAY THIS

“For any feature touching card data I design to **minimise PCI scope** — tokenise early, never persist CVV, segment the CDE — so we stay compliant and reduce breach surface. Compliance is a design input from story one, not a final gate.” That directly answers the JD's “PCI DSS compliance” line.

KYC / AML (links to the CAMS certification)

- **KYC** — Know Your Customer: verify identity (CIP), understand the customer, risk-rate them.
- **AML** — Anti-Money-Laundering: screen against sanctions/PEP lists, monitor transactions, file **SARs/STRs** (suspicious activity/transaction reports).
- **CDD / EDD** — Customer / Enhanced Due Diligence for higher-risk customers.
- **PDPA** (Malaysia) governs personal-data handling; design with consent & data-minimisation.

A product owner “bakes in” KYC/AML and data protection — capturing the right data points, consent, screening hooks and audit trails — rather than bolting them on later.

12 · System architecture diagrams — step by step

This is the part you were asked about last time. A system architecture diagram answers one question: “**what are the parts, and how do they talk to each other?**” Here's a method you can run live on a whiteboard.

The 8-step method

1. **Clarify scope & requirements first.** Functional (what it does) + non-functional — scale (users/TPS), latency, availability, security, and **compliance** (BNM, PDPA, PCI, Shariah). Stating these out loud is half the score.
2. **Identify actors & external systems.** Customers/staff on the left; outside systems (CCRIS, CTOS, PayNet, MyKad) on the right.
3. **List components by capability** — “Origination service”, “Credit decisioning”, “Pricing”, “Servicing”. One box = one responsibility.
4. **Add data stores** — each owning service gets a datastore (cylinder); mark the core & the warehouse.
5. **Group into layers** — Channels → Edge/Security → Application → Integration → Core → Data. Layering shows flow direction.
6. **Draw & label every connection** — direction + protocol + purpose: “REST/HTTPS – submit application”, “event (Kafka) – loan booked”, “SQL – read balance”, “SFTP – nightly CCRIS batch”. An unlabeled arrow is wasted.
7. **Mark trust boundaries & cross-cutting concerns** — DMZ vs internal; where auth/MFA, the API gateway, WAF, logging & encryption sit.
8. **Validate & simplify** — walk one journey through it, confirm every hop, then add a legend and keep shapes consistent.

LEVELS — THE C4 MODEL

Draw at zoom levels: **Context** (system + users/neighbours) → **Container** (apps, services, DBs) → **Component** (inside one service) → **Code**. Start at Context, zoom to Container, and say which level you're at.

Tools: [draw.io / diagrams.net](https://draw.io) [Lucidchart](https://lucidchart.com) [Visio](https://visio.microsoft.com) [Excalidraw](https://excalidraw.com) [Miro](https://miro.com) [PlantUML / Mermaid \(diagram-as-code\)](https://plantuml.com)

13 · The shapes & how connections work

The visual vocabulary you asked for. Use shapes **consistently** — same kind of thing = same shape.

Shape vocabulary



User / Actor



Service / Application



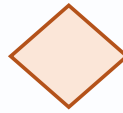
Database / Datastore



Message queue / topic



External system / Internet



Decision / Router



Gateway (API / payment)



Component / Module

Connections



Synchronous call (REST / gRPC)



Async event / message



Bidirectional / sync both ways

The core visual vocabulary. Pick a style and stay consistent throughout a diagram.

How a connection “reads”

ENCODED BY	TELLS THE READER	EXAMPLE
Direction (arrowhead)	Who initiates	App → Core (app calls the core)
Line style	Sync vs async	solid = request/response · dashed = event
Label	Protocol + purpose	“REST/HTTPS – get balance”, “Kafka – payment.posted”

REST / HTTPS

gRPC

GraphQL

SOAP (legacy core)

Kafka / events

MQ / JMS

SQL / JDBC

SFTP batch

ISO 8583 (cards)

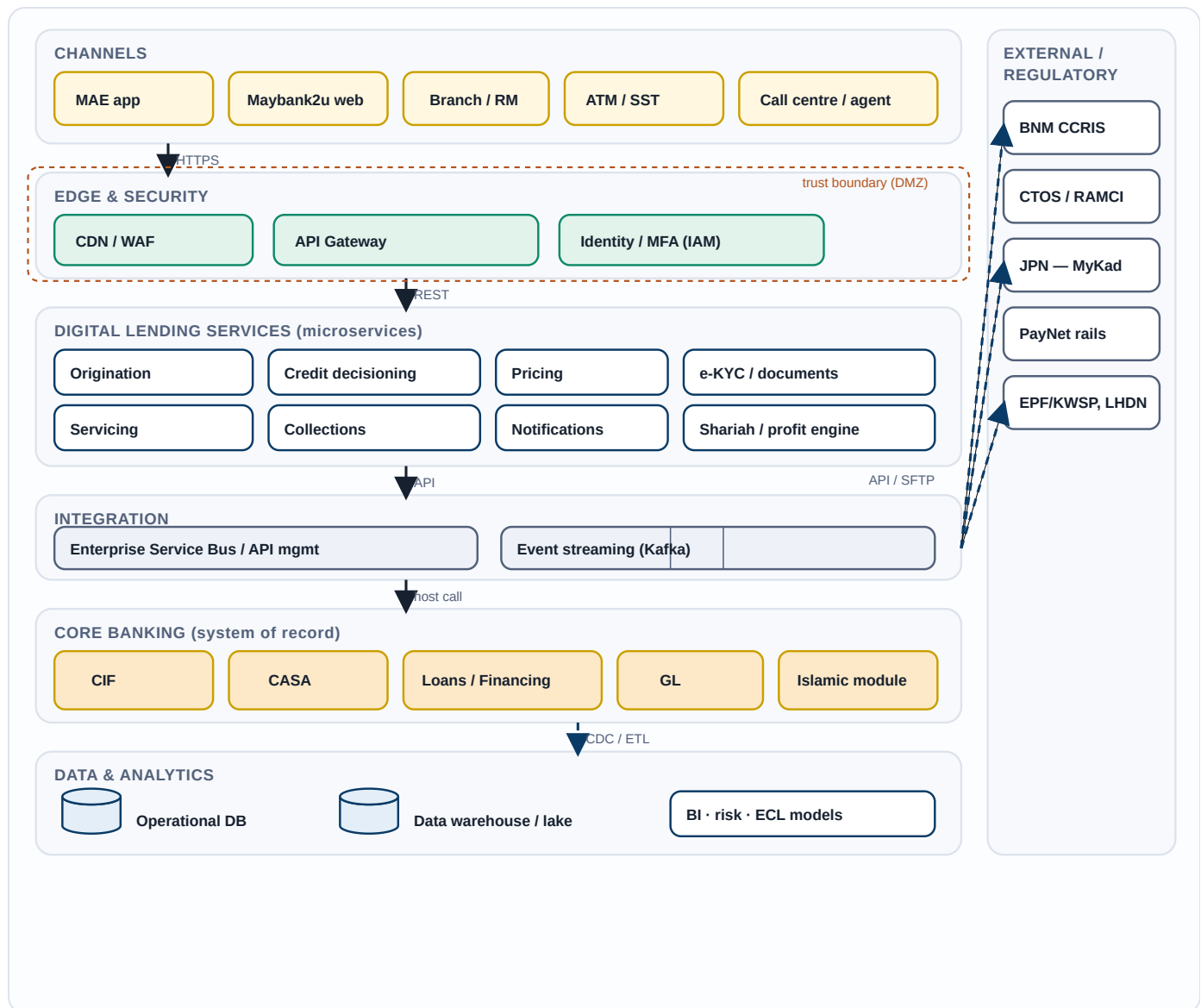
ISO 20022 (payments)

THE RULE THAT WINS POINTS

“**Synchronous** when the caller needs the answer now (balance check, payment auth, a credit decision the customer is waiting on). **Async/event** when it can run in the background (SMS, analytics, downstream updates). Decoupling with events keeps the core stable and channels fast.” Saying *when* to use each is what separates a strong candidate.

14 · Worked example: Maybank lending architecture

A **Container-level** diagram for a digital home-financing journey. Note the layers, labelled connections, and regulatory externals. Practise narrating it top-to-bottom.



Container-level view of a Maybank-style digital lending platform. Yellow = Maybank-owned core; solid arrows = synchronous; dashed = asynchronous/batch; the dashed orange box is a security trust boundary.

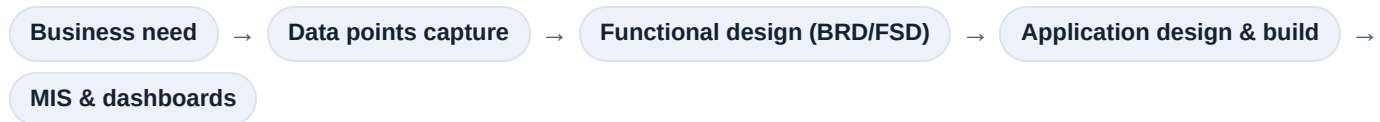
Narrate it in 30 seconds

“A customer applies on **MAE** or **M2U**. Traffic passes the **WAF** and **API gateway**, authenticated by **IAM/MFA** — that's the trust boundary. **Origination** orchestrates the journey, calling **e-KYC** (verifies MyKad via **JPN**), **Credit decisioning** (pulls **CCRIS** + **CTOS**, computes DSR, applies the **rating**), then **Pricing** (SBR + spread, or the Shariah profit engine). On approval we book the facility into the **core Loans** module, which posts to the **GL**. Servicing/Collections run off the core; we publish **events** to Kafka so Notifications and the **warehouse** update asynchronously. Payments settle through **PayNet**.”

15 · Functional design → MIS & data viz JD

The JD wants “functional design — from critical data points capture to application design, development & MIS creation,” plus “data visualization.” This is the PO-to-build pipeline.

From need to spec to report



ARTEFACT	WHAT IT CAPTURES
Data points / data dictionary	The exact fields to capture (e.g. income, employment, collateral value), their type, source, validation, and whether they feed decisioning, MIS or both.
BRD — Business Requirements Document	The “what & why” in business language — goals, scope, rules.
FSD — Functional Spec Document	The “how it behaves” — screens, fields, validations, workflows, edge cases, NFRs.
MIS — Management Information System	Reports & dashboards that turn captured data into decisions (approval rates, GIL, ECL staging, funnel).

THE PO INSIGHT

“If I don't **capture the right data point at origination**, I can't report on it later. So functional design starts from the **MIS I'll need** and works backwards to the **fields to capture** — design the report and the data dictionary together.” This single idea links the JD's “data points capture → MIS creation.”

Data visualization — choosing the right view

QUESTION	CHART
Trend over time (e.g. NIM, GIL by month)	Line chart
Compare categories (outstanding by product)	Bar / column
Part-to-whole (portfolio mix, CASA ratio)	Stacked bar / donut (sparingly)
Drop-off through steps (application funnel)	Funnel chart
Distribution (DSR or score bands)	Histogram
Status at a glance (KPIs vs target)	KPI cards / gauges

Tools to name: Power BI Tableau QlikView/Qlik Sense Looker · *good dashboards lead with the decision, not the data*
— *one screen, a clear KPI, drill-downs underneath.*

16 · SQL basics for a banking PO JD

The JD asks for “basic SQL.” You won't write production SQL, but you'll **read** it, request data and validate numbers. Essentials on a tiny loan schema.

The mental model

Data lives in **tables** (rows = records, columns = fields), linked by **keys**: a **primary key (PK)** uniquely identifies a row; a **foreign key (FK)** points to another table's PK.

TABLE	KEY COLUMNS
customers	customer_id (PK), name, mykad, income
loans	loan_id (PK), customer_id (FK), product, outstanding, rate, status, months_in_arrears
payments	payment_id (PK), loan_id (FK), paid_on, amount

The 6 clauses that do 90% of the work

```
-- SELECT what · FROM where · WHERE filter · GROUP aggregate · ORDER sort · LIMIT cut
SELECT product, COUNT(*) AS num_loans, SUM(outstanding) AS total_owed
FROM    loans
WHERE   status = 'active'
GROUP BY product
HAVING SUM(outstanding) > 1000000
ORDER BY total_owed DESC
LIMIT 10;
```

JOINS

```
-- Customer name next to each loan (INNER = only matching rows)
SELECT c.name, l.product, l.outstanding
FROM    customers c
JOIN    loans l ON l.customer_id = c.customer_id;
```

JOIN	RETURNS
INNER JOIN	Only rows matching in both tables.
LEFT JOIN	All left rows + matches (NULLs where none).
RIGHT / FULL JOIN	Mirror of LEFT / both sides.

Banking queries you can talk through

```
-- Gross impaired loan (GIL) ratio by product
SELECT product,
       SUM(CASE WHEN months_in_arrears >= 3 THEN outstanding ELSE 0 END)
       / SUM(outstanding) AS gil_ratio
FROM   loans
GROUP BY product;
```

- **Aggregates:** COUNT, SUM, AVG, MIN, MAX + GROUP BY / HAVING .
- **Filters:** WHERE, DISTINCT, IN, BETWEEN, LIKE, IS NULL .
- **CTEs:** WITH active AS (SELECT ...) SELECT ... FROM active .
- **Window functions:** ROW_NUMBER() OVER(...) , running totals (high-level awareness).
- **DDL vs DML:** CREATE/ALTER/DROP define; INSERT/UPDATE/DELETE change; SELECT reads.

INTERVIEW-SAFE ANSWER

“I’d GROUP BY product with SUM(outstanding) , joining loans to customers on customer_id , filtering status='active' .” Showing you can **shape a query** and reason about joins is the goal — perfect syntax isn't required.

17 · Product ownership, AGILE, JIRA & Confluence JD

The PO owns **what** gets built and **why**; the team owns the **how**. In a bank you also own the bridge to **risk, compliance & Shariah**.

Scrum in one table

ROLE / EVENT	WHO / WHAT
Product Owner	Owns & prioritises the backlog; maximises value; accepts work.
Scrum Master	Owns the process; removes blockers.
Dev team	Owns the build & estimates.
Sprint planning	Commit the sprint backlog.
Backlog refinement	Clarify & size upcoming stories.
Daily stand-up	15-min sync.
Review & retrospective	Show increment; improve the process.

The PO toolkit

TOOL	USE
Vision & roadmap	Problem → prioritised roadmap tied to OKRs (raise digital approvals, cut time-to-yes).
Backlog	Epics → features → user stories, ordered by value.
User story	As a <role>, I want <goal>, so that <benefit> + acceptance criteria.
Acceptance criteria	Gherkin Given/When/Then ; testable.
INVEST	Story quality: Independent, Negotiable, Valuable, Estimable, Small, Testable.
Prioritisation	MoSCoW , RICE , WSJF , Kano, value-vs-effort.
Metrics	Adoption, funnel conversion, NPS, approval rate, cost-to-serve, NPL guardrail.

JIRA & Confluence (named in the JD)

TOOL	YOU USE IT TO...
JIRA	Create epics & stories , manage the backlog , run sprints on a board, track velocity & burndown.
Confluence	Document the BRD/FSD, decisions, runbooks, release notes — the team's knowledge base, linked from JIRA.

A model user story (digital home financing)

Story: *As a salaried applicant, I want to e-submit my income documents and instantly see an indicative financing amount, so that I know my eligibility before committing.*

Acceptance (Gherkin): Given a verified customer · When they upload payslips & consent to a CCRIS check · Then the system computes DSR and returns an indicative amount within 60s, or a clear reason.

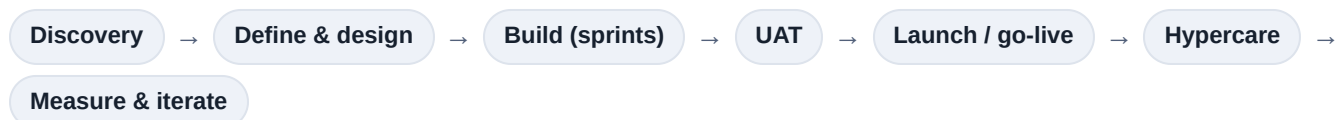
Compliance/NFR: PDPA consent logged; decision explainable for adverse-action; Shariah variant available; audit trail retained.

Stakeholders, ambiguity & leadership JD

- **International stakeholders:** Bengaluru squad ↔ KL business/risk/Shariah. Over-communicate, align on outcomes, manage time-zones.
- **Navigating ambiguity:** when requirements are unclear, frame a hypothesis, ship a thin slice, measure, iterate — don't wait for perfect clarity.
- **Mentoring technical teams:** grow BAs/juniors, give context not just tasks, lead delivery without owning the code (T.I.G.E.R. “Growth”).

18 · Product lifecycle & implementation JD

“Responsible for the end-to-end product lifecycle” and “Product Implementation” — own the product from idea to in-market performance, not just delivery.



PHASE	WHAT YOU OWN
Discovery	Problem, customer & market research, business case, success metrics.
Define & design	BRD/FSD, data points, journeys, prioritised scope; risk/compliance/Shariah sign-off.
Build	Backlog, sprint delivery, accept/reject vs Definition of Done.
UAT	Business validates against acceptance criteria before go-live.
Implementation / go-live	Release plan, change management, training, cutover, rollback plan.
Hypercare	Heightened support post-launch; fix fast, watch the metrics.
Measure & iterate	Read the MIS, learn, feed the next roadmap increment.

END-TO-END OWNERSHIP LINE

“I own outcomes, not output — from the **business case** through **go-live** and **hypercare** to the **in-market metrics**, then I iterate. Implementation isn't the finish line; the adoption and risk numbers are.”

19 · Certifications: CAMS · KYC · FRM JD

CERT	WHAT IT IS	SIGNALS
CAMS	Certified Anti-Money-Laundering Specialist (ACAMS).	Deep AML/sanctions/financial-crime knowledge.
KYC	Know-Your-Customer certifications/CDD training.	Onboarding, due diligence, identity risk.
FRM	Financial Risk Manager (GARP).	Credit/market/operational risk, Basel, quant risk.

*You don't need these to interview well — but knowing what each **signals** lets you speak to AML, KYC and risk credibly, and to say which you'd pursue (FRM pairs naturally with this rating/pricing/risk-analytics role).*

20 · Interview Q&A — drill these

Domain

Q

Walk me through the end-to-end loan lifecycle.

A

Application (e-KYC vs MyKad) → credit assessment (CCRIS + CTOS, verify income, DSR under BNM rules) → approval & pricing (rating → SBR + spread, or Islamic profit rate; Letter of Offer) → acceptance & disbursement (facility agreement, charge under NLC, stamp duty, MRTA) → servicing (instalments, accrual, CCRIS reporting) → delinquency (months in arrears, impaired ~90 DPD) → rehabilitation (R&R / AKPK) → recovery (foreclosure/repossession, MFRS 9 provisions) → settlement & discharge.

Q

How does a rating system connect to risk-based pricing?

A

The rating produces a **PD** (obligor) and, with collateral, an **LGD** (facility). Those give **Expected Loss = PD × LGD × EAD**, which becomes the credit-risk component of the spread. Worse grade → higher PD → higher EL → higher price. So: **rating → PD/LGD → EL → spread → rate**.

Q

Explain deposit management and why it matters to a lending PO.

A

Deposits (CASA, fixed deposits) are the **liabilities** that fund loans. The **CASA ratio** drives **cost of funds**, which is the floor under loan pricing and a key part of **NIM**. **ALM** matches the two sides for interest-rate and liquidity risk (LCR/NSFR). A lending product is only profitable relative to what its funding costs.

Q

What's the difference between conventional and Islamic financing?

A

Conventional charges interest (**riba**); Islamic avoids it by structuring a real transaction — Tawarruq for personal financing, Musharakah Mutanaqisah for home — earning **profit** with Shariah Committee approval. Same lifecycle, different contract and language.

Architecture & tech

Q

What is core banking and why not build everything in it?

A

Core banking is the system of record — CIF, CASA, loans, GL — where authoritative balances live. We change it rarely because ledger errors are catastrophic. Innovation goes in a **digital/microservices layer** that talks to the core via **APIs and events**, so we ship fast without risking the books.

Q

Draw the architecture for a digital financing journey. (See §14.)

A

Layer it: Channels (MAE/M2U) → Edge (WAF, API gateway, MFA = trust boundary) → Lending microservices (origination, e-KYC, decisioning, pricing) → Integration (ESB + Kafka) → Core (loans + GL) → Data. Externals: CCRIS, CTOS, MyKad, PayNet. Solid arrows = synchronous, dashed = async/batch. Then narrate one journey through it and name the protocol on each hop.

Q

Sync vs async — when do you use each?

A

Synchronous when the caller needs the answer now — balance check, payment auth, a credit decision the customer waits on. Async/event for background work — SMS, analytics, downstream updates. Events decouple services and protect the core from load.

Q

How do you keep a card feature PCI DSS-compliant?

A

Minimise scope: **tokenise** the PAN early, **never store the CVV**, encrypt card data at rest & in transit, segment the cardholder-data environment, and enforce least-privilege access with full logging. Compliance is a design input, not a final gate.

Product ownership

Q

You have 20 backlog items and one sprint — how do you prioritise?

A

Score value-vs-effort with **RICE/WSJF**, then overlay two banking non-negotiables: **regulatory/Shariah must-haves** and **risk**. Anything legally required or blocking go-live jumps the queue (MoSCoW “Must”). I sequence the rest by customer value and dependencies and socialise the trade-offs transparently.

Q

How do you write a good user story for a lending feature?

A

As a **salaried applicant**, I want an instant indicative financing amount, so that I know my **eligibility**. Then Given/When/Then acceptance criteria, plus explicit NFRs: PDPA consent, explainable decision for adverse-action, Shariah variant, audit trail. INVEST keeps it small and testable.

Q

How would you measure success of a new digital financing product?

A

A north-star (completed digital applications) + a balanced set: funnel conversion & drop-off, time-to-yes, digital adoption, approval/decline rates, NPS, cost-to-serve — and a guardrail the risk team owns: early-stage delinquency / NPL, so we're not “winning” by approving bad credit.

Q

How do you handle ambiguity and conflicting international stakeholders?

A

Align everyone on the **outcome** and the metric first; surface the disagreement explicitly; use data to choose; and de-risk by shipping a thin slice to learn rather than debating in the abstract. Across Bengaluru–KL I over-communicate in writing (Confluence) and keep one prioritised backlog (JIRA) as the single source of truth.

Q

A compliance constraint blocks the feature customers want. What do you do?

A

Compliance isn't optional, so I reframe: understand the exact rule (BNM/PDPA/PCI/Shariah) with risk, then find a compliant design that delivers most of the value — staged consent, an alternative contract, manual-now-automate-later. Document the trade-off and the path to the ideal state.

Behavioural (use STAR + T.I.G.E.R.)

Situation → Task → Action → Result, finishing on a quantified result. Have ready: a prioritisation trade-off (Excellence/Efficiency), a stakeholder conflict resolved (Relationship Building), mentoring a junior (Growth), a compliance-driven redesign (Integrity), a delivery saved by the squad (Teamwork).

ASK THEM BACK

“How does this squad balance speed of delivery against core-banking change-control and Shariah-governance cycles, working across Bengaluru and KL?” — shows you understand the real tension in this role.

21 · Glossary

ALM

Asset-Liability Management — matching assets vs liabilities for rate & liquidity risk.

AKPK

BNM credit-counselling & debt-management agency.

AML

Anti-Money-Laundering.

Basel III

Global capital & liquidity framework.

BNM

Bank Negara Malaysia — central bank/regulator.

BRD / FSD

Business / Functional spec documents.

CAMS

Certified Anti-Money-Laundering Specialist.

CASA

Current Account & Savings Account.

CCRIS

BNM's central credit database.

CIF

Customer Information File — golden customer record.

Cost of funds

Weighted rate paid for deposits/borrowings.

CTOS

Private credit reporting agency/score.

DSR

Debt Service Ratio (Malaysia's DTI).

EAD

Exposure at Default.

ECL / MFRS 9

Expected Credit Loss provisioning standard.

FRM

Financial Risk Manager (GARP).

GIL

Gross Impaired Loans ratio.

GL

General Ledger.

IRB

Internal Ratings-Based capital approach (Basel).

LCR / NSFR

Liquidity Coverage / Net Stable Funding ratios.

LGD

Loss Given Default.

LOS / LMS

Loan Origination / Management (servicing) System.

MIS

Management Information System — reports/dashboards.

MOF

Margin of Finance ($\approx$ LTV).

NIM

Net Interest Margin.

NLC

National Land Code (property charges/foreclosure).

OPR → SBR

BNM benchmark rate → Standardised Base Rate.

PCI DSS

Card-data security standard.

PD

Probability of Default.

PDPA

Personal Data Protection Act 2010.

R&R

Rescheduling & Restructuring.

RWA

Risk-Weighted Assets.

SAR / STR

Suspicious Activity / Transaction Report.

Tawarruq

Commodity-Murabahah Islamic cash financing.

T.I.G.E.R.

Maybank values: Teamwork, Integrity, Growth, Excellence
& Efficiency, Relationship Building.

UAT

User Acceptance Testing.

WSJF

Weighted Shortest Job First (prioritisation).

22 · One-page cheat sheet

Employer

MBB Labs = Maybank's **Bengaluru** ODC, a software product org. Maybank: 4th-largest SEA bank, RM722bn, 20 countries, all 10 ASEAN, Islamic-finance leader, “humanise financial services.” Values = **T.I.G.E.R.**

JD spine — say these confidently

Core banking = system of record Rating → PD/LGD Risk-based pricing = SBR + spread
Deposits fund loans (CASA, cost of funds, NIM, ALM) PCI DSS: tokenise, never store CVV KYC/AML/CAMS
Functional design: data points → BRD/FSD → MIS AGILE + JIRA + Confluence basic SQL

Loan lifecycle (9)

Application Credit assessment Approval & pricing Offer & disbursement Servicing Delinquency Rehabilitation
Recovery Settlement

The pricing chain

rating → PD & LGD → EL = PD×LGD×EAD → spread → customer rate (SBR + spread)

Diagram — 8 steps + connections

1 Requirements (incl. compliance) 2 Actors & externals 3 Components by capability 4 Datastores 5 Layer it
6 Label every connection 7 Trust boundaries 8 Validate & simplify

solid = **sync** (REST) · dashed = **async** (Kafka) · cylinder = DB · hexagon = gateway · label **direction+protocol+purpose**
· levels = **C4** Context → Container → Component.

SQL spine

SELECT cols FROM t [JOIN t2 ON ...] WHERE ... GROUP BY ... HAVING ... ORDER BY ... LIMIT n;

Product ownership

Vision → roadmap → OKRs epic → feature → story As a... I want... so that... Given/When/Then INVEST
MoSCoW/RICE/WSJF end-to-end lifecycle + hypercare STAR + T.I.G.E.R.

Educational interview-prep material for the MBB Labs / Maybank Senior Product Owner role. Summarises publicly known concepts and common market practice; internal bank systems evolve and are not fully public — present vendor/stack details as industry-reported, and verify current BNM/PCI/Basel rules. Not legal, financial, or Shariah advice.